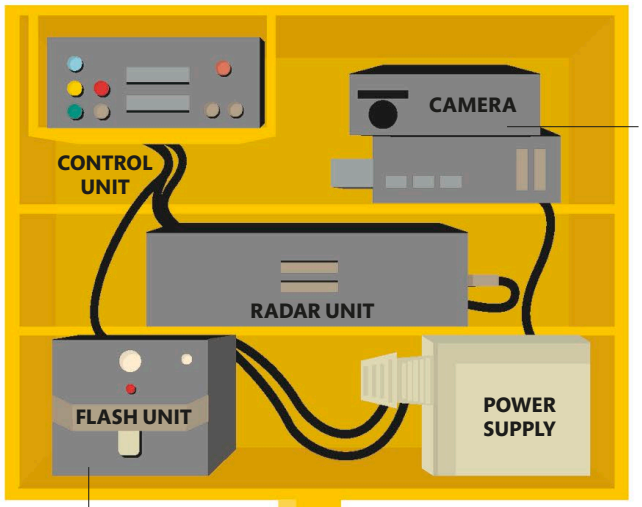
INSIDE A SPEED CAMERA

A speed camera houses a radar unit, camera, power supply, and control unit. It usually points at the backs of vehicles so that the flash of the camera does not dazzle drivers.



Digital camera photographs speeding vehicles

Flash unit illuminates license plate for identification

LIDAR

Some handheld speed detectors fire a series of laser pulses at vehicles and measure the return time of reflected pulses to calculate a vehicle's distance and speed. This technique is known as LiDAR (Light Detection and Ranging).



SPEED CAMERA



Mounting pole holds camera at required height and angle

Reflected waves have a longer wavelength

3 Reception
The radar unit receives some of the reflected microwaves. If their longer wavelength indicates a speed above the speed limit, a digital camera is activated to photograph the car.

WHEN WERE SPEED CAMERAS INVENTED?

Although the idea of developing speed cameras dates back to at least the early 1900s, the first radar speed cameras were made in the US for military use during World War II.